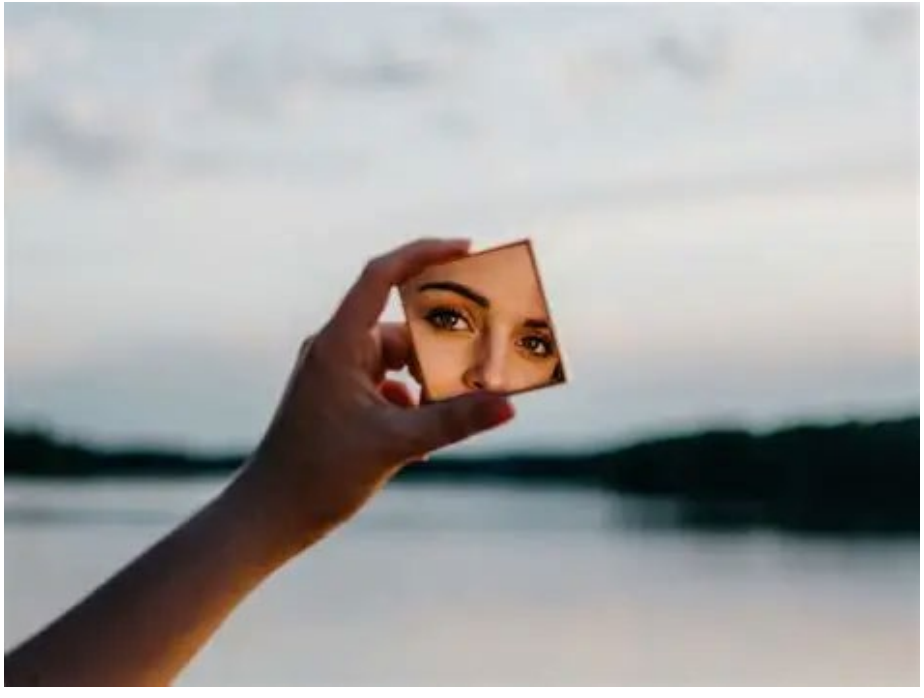
SAT101 ALC
Great Big Workshop
Reflective Writing



Today's Workshop
All about Portfolio Task 3.

Part One – The Task

- What you are doing – The Task sheet
- How you are marked – The Descriptors
- How to get a higher mark – Writing Advice

Part Two – What? – So What? – Now What?

For each section

- What to write.
- What not to write.
- Cohesive Devices for each section.
- How to link Sections.

Week 8 -
Make it great!

Room

EB352

Tues
Alex - 10:15am - Help with Writing Under Pressure
Rick - 12:15pm - Reflective Writing
James - 1:15pm - Help with Writing Under Pressure

Weds
Hunter 9:45am - Reflective Writing

Thurs
Ashlee - 1:15pm - Reflective Writing

Fri
Alex - 10:15am - Reflective Writing
James - 11:15pm - Help with Writing Under Pressure
Ashlee - 1:15pm -Reflective Writing

XJTLU | ACADEMIC LITERACIES CENTRE

Go to these events if at all possible!

Useful Resources

- All the material for week 2 is relevant!
- But especially the week 2 workbook has a full model answer.
  - https://core.xjtlu.edu.cn/mod/resource/view.php?id=36895
- There are vocubulary reviews for most weeks in the Week 7 section.
  - https://core.xjtlu.edu.cn/mod/h5pactivity/view.php?id=52724
- Video giving feedback for practice writing task:
  - https://core.xjtlu.edu.cn/mod/h5pactivity/view.php?id=52381

The Task sheet

Assignment:

Write a reflective essay on one of the practical tasks accomplished on the module

Time:

Semester 1, Week 9 In you usual tutorial sessions in your usual classrooms.

Assessment Details

Assessment Type: reflective writing
submission method: in-class, on exam paper Pen and Paper
Percentage of module mark: 10%
Learning Outcomes assessed: A, B, E
Duration: 50 minutes

Assessment Task

For this assessment task, you are invited to reflect on a specific practical component of your AI app design project. The goal is to critically evaluate your personal development throughout the project, including your technical and professional learning, your role in the project, and how you intend to apply this experience in future engineering or design contexts.

This task is not just about describing what happened, but about demonstrating your ability to think critically about your experiences and connect them to the broader themes and concepts covered in the module.

Requirements

Your reflection should be between 400 and 600 words in length and written in academic English. It must be structured into three key sections:

- What? – Describe the specific practical component you are reflecting on. What did you do? What was your role in the project? What challenges did you face?
- So What? – Analyze and reflect on the significance of your experience. What did you learn? How did it relate to the module content? What does it tell you about your skills, knowledge, and professional development?
- Now What? – Consider the future. How will you apply what you have learned in this project to future engineering or design situations? What changes might you make based on this experience?

We'll cover this in detail in the second half!

A Note on Speed

- You will be required to write 400-600 words in 50 minutes.
- This is a lot!
- You won’t necessarily fail if you are under the word count, but you may lose marks if you have not fully addressed the task.
- Be aware of this pressure and don’t waste time.
  - Planning and checking are not a waste of time!

Use Examples

You are encouraged to use specific examples from your own experience in the course. For instance, use concrete examples to illustrate your reflections and to demonstrate your understanding of the module content—such as AI design principles, ethical considerations, or technical methods like prompt engineering or Retrieval-Augmented Generation. In addition, you need to demonstrate critical thinking by evaluating your actions, decisions, and overall learning. Show how this experience has contributed to your development as a designer or engineer and how you plan to grow in the future.

Reflective Writing Marking Descriptors

Points	Task	Coherence and Cohesion	Vocabulary	Grammar
25	Comprehensive and insightful reflection: clear description, deep analysis, and thoughtful future application. Demonstrates critical thinking and thorough module content awareness.	There is strong cohesion between paragraphs and sections. Uses a variety of cohesive features within and between paragraphs. Any instances of over-, under-, or misuse of cohesive features occur only as slips.	Uses a wide range of lexis with some precision. The vast majority of sentences are error free, and any errors with lexis and academic style are minor.	The vast majority of sentences are error free, and any errors are minor. Wording is only occasionally awkward.
20	Clear reflection with only minor gaps: adequate description, reasonable analysis, and some future thinking. Some knowledge of module content. Uses several specific examples from own experience.	Uses a range of cohesive features. Over-, under-, or misuse is rare and minor. There may be cohesive links between paragraphs.	Lexical range is wide, allowing for frequent reformulation as appropriate. Most sentences are error free.	Uses a wide range of complex structures. Most sentences are error free, although sometimes awkward. Errors are minor.
15	Reflection covers relevant points and demonstrates knowledge of the course, but ideas may not all be fully developed. Uses examples from own experience which may not always be directly relevant.	All paragraphs have clear central topics, and ideas within the paragraphs are coherently arranged. Uses a range of cohesive features but with some over-, under-, or misuse.	There is topic-specific lexis, and the range of lexis is wide enough to avoid frequent repetition. Errors or awkward wording are frequent but rarely reduce clarity. There are only occasional basic errors	The range of complex structures is wide enough to avoid frequent repetition. Errors or awkward wording are frequent but rarely reduce clarity. There are only occasional basic errors
10	Basic reflection: description present, limited insight or vague next steps. Basic knowledge of module content. Uses at least one specific example from own experience.	Uses a range of cohesive features with some over-, under-, or misuse, but errors do not reduce clarity.	Lexical range is wide enough to allow some reformulation as appropriate. Errors with lexis and academic style may be frequent but do not reduce clarity.	Range of complex structures allows for a variety of sentence lengths. Errors and awkward wording may be frequent but do not reduce clarity. Basic errors are rare.
5	Minimal or unclear reflection; lacks relevance or depth. One step of the reflection may be missing. No demonstration of module content knowledge.	Some paragraphs do not have clear central topics, and/or not all ideas are coherently arranged. Cohesive features lack range and are often over-, under-, or misused.	Lexical range is adequate for academic tasks. Error density is high, and/or errors sometimes reduce clarity.	Range of complex structures is limited, and/or there are some basic errors, and/or errors sometimes reduce clarity.
0	Content not relevant to task	Paragraphing may be lacking or illogical. Cohesive features are basic, inaccurate, lacking, and/or repetitive.	Lexical range is minimally adequate for academic tasks, and/or the density of basic errors is high, and/or errors often reduce clarity.	Grammar is simple, and/or the density of basic errors is high, and/or errors often reduce clarity.

Task

25 - Comprehensive and insightful **reflection**: clear **description**, deep analysis, and thoughtful future application. Demonstrates critical thinking and thorough **module content** awareness

15 - **Reflection** covers relevant points and demonstrates **knowledge of the course**, but ideas may not all be fully developed. Uses examples from own experience which may not always be directly relevant.

5 - Minimal or unclear **reflection**; lacks relevance or depth. <u>One step of the reflection may be missing</u>. No demonstration of **module content knowledge**

20 - Clear **reflection** with only minor gaps: adequate **description**, reasonable analysis, and some future thinking. Some **knowledge of module content**. Uses several specific examples from own experience.

10 - Basic **reflection**: **description** present, limited insight or vague next steps. Basic **knowledge of module content**. Uses at least one specific example from own experience

0 - Content not relevant to task

Grammar

- This asks you to do two contradictory things.
  - Try complex structures.
  - Write error free sentences.
- If you can write complex error-free sentences, great!
- Otherwise use a mix of simple and complex sentences.

Grammar
The vast majority of sentences are error free, and any errors are minor. Wording is only occasionally awkward.
Uses a wide range of complex structures. Most sentences are error free, although sometimes awkward. Errors are minor.
The range of complex structures is wide enough to avoid frequent repetition. Errors or awkward wording are frequent but rarely reduce clarity. There are only occasional basic errors
Range of complex structures allows for a variety of sentence lengths. Errors and awkward wording may be frequent but do not reduce clarity. Basic errors are rare.
Range of complex structures is limited, and/or there are some basic errors, and/or errors sometimes reduce clarity.
Grammar is simple, and/or the density of basic errors is high, and/or errors often reduce clarity.

Tenses

- The task sheet specifically says…
  - What did you do? (What)
  - What does it tell you about your skills? (So What)
  - How will you apply what you have learned? (Now What)
- You will need to use past, present, and future tense all the same essay.

What is a complex structure?

- More complex tenses – perfect (“have made”), continuous (“am making”)
- Passive voice (“is made”)
- More complex verb phrases (“needed to be able to fully understand…”)
- Longer and linked clauses (“Because I had fully researched the task, I was able to solve the problem”)
- Relative clauses (“The problem which was most difficult to solve was…”)
- All used only when appropriate.

Vocabulary

- Important phrases
  - “Academic style/adequate for academic tasks”
  - “Topic-specific lexis”
  - “Allowing for frequent reformulation/avoid frequent repetition”
  - “Do not reduce clarity.”

Vocabulary
Uses a wide range of lexis with some precision. The vast majority of sentences are error free, and any errors with lexis and academic style are minor.
Lexical range is wide, allowing for frequent reformulation as appropriate. Most sentences are error free.
There is topic-specific lexis, and the range of lexis is wide enough to avoid frequent repetition. Errors or awkward wording are frequent but rarely reduce clarity. There are only occasional basic errors
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Academic Reflective Style

- You will be talking about yourself – you should use ‘I’
- You should talk about your opinions – ‘I believe’ – but these opinions should be based on sensible analysis.
- You should be **muted** with emotions.
  - Not **angry** → **frustrated** with the issue
  - Not **happy** → **satisfied** with the result

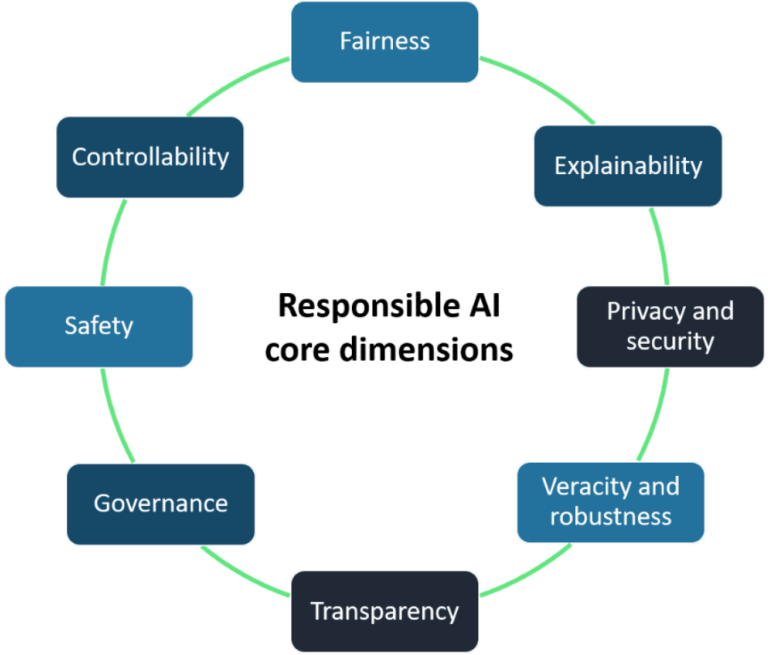
Topic-Specific Words

- Words about your topic
  - The topic is AI (see next slide)
  - Also engineering projects…
    - design phase, concept, specifications
  - Also university learning…
    - collaborative, assessment, learning objectives, deadline

Look at lecture slides for good vocabulary

Core Dimensions of Responsible AI

- **Fairness**: prevents discrimination, aligns with legal and ethical standards, and fosters social trust.
- **Explainability**: Ensures AI decisions are understandable to humans by providing clear justifications for outcomes.
- **Transparency**: Discloses system processes, capabilities, and limitations, enabling stakeholders to assess fairness, robustness, and potential biases.
- **Privacy and Security**: Protects personal data by giving individuals control over its use and preventing unauthorized access.
- **Governance**: Establishes processes to define, implement, and enforce responsible AI practices, addressing ethical, legal, and societal concerns.



Look at tutorial workbooks

- Most weeks contains vocabulary lists.
- You won’t use everything in one essay but try to use at least two or three really good words.

Words	Definitions
1. User Interface (n.)	a. the process of getting something back from a system, store, or database.
2. generate (v.)	b. to use something to maximum advantage, often to achieve a specific goal.
3. leverage (v.)	c. to improve something by making small changes; to purify or make more precise.
4. tone (n.)	d. to produce or create something.
5. augment (v.)	e. to push gently or persuade subtly to influence a decision or outcome.
6. retrieval (n.)	f. the style, manner, or emotional quality of a model's output (e.g., formal, cheerful, sympathetic).
7. nudge (v.)	g. to think, understand, and form conclusions logically.
8. refine (v.)	h. the point of human-computer interaction (everything you see, touch, or click on).
9. reason (v.)	i. the repetition of a process in order to generate a sequence of outcomes.
10. iteration (n.)	j. to make something larger or more effective by adding to it.

Repetition

- You want to avoid using the same word again and again. Demonstrate your wide vocabulary!
  - Make, built, create, produce
  - Issue, problem, flaw, weakness
- Be careful not to use words you are not completely sure the meaning of.
- If you have time, check for repetition at the end.

What are cohesion and coherence?

- Coherence – how easy the essay is for a marker to understand.
- Cohesion – how well the sections of the essay fit together.

In other words, the essay needs to flow well and be logically organized.

Cohesion and Coherence

- “Uses a range of cohesive features”
- “Paragraphs have clear central topics.”
- “There may be cohesive links between paragraphs.”

Coherence and Cohesion
There is strong cohesion between paragraphs and sections. Uses a variety of cohesive features within and between paragraphs. Any instances of over-, under-, or misuse of cohesive features occur only as slips.
Uses a range of cohesive features. Over-, under-, or misuse is rare and minor. There may be cohesive links between paragraphs.
All paragraphs have clear central topics, and ideas within the paragraphs are coherently arranged. Uses a range of cohesive features but with some over-, under-, or misuse.
Uses a range of cohesive features with some over-, under-, or misuse, but errors do not reduce clarity.
Some paragraphs do not have clear central topics, and/or not all ideas are coherently arranged. Cohesive features lack range and are often over-, under-, or misused.
Paragraphing may be lacking or illogical. Cohesive features are basic, inaccurate, lacking, and/or repetitive.

“Uses a range of cohesive features.”

- Linking words – ***However, but, moveover***
  - Show the link between this sentence and the previous one.
- Reference Pronouns – ***This issue, That application***
  - Refers back to something previously mentioned.
- Signposting language – ***One example of…, In conclusion***
  - Clearly tells the reader the purpose of the sentence.
- More on these later...

“Paragraphs have clear central topics.”

- You will have learnt this in Year One.
- It’s easy to forget it because reflective writing can feel less formal than traditional academic essays.
- You need to be clear what the topic of each paragraph is going to be, stick to it, and clearly state it (ideally) in the first sentence.
- We’ll look at possible topics for each section in a moment.

“Cohesive Links between Paragraphs”

- This is more difficult to do than cohesive links between sentences.
- But actually in our What?-So What?-Now What? essays isn’t too difficult.
  - A problem (in So What?) happens during a task described in What
  - A resolution for the future (in Now What?) comes from the solution to that problem (in So What?)

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University
西交利物浦大学

ALC SAT101 CS Workshop

Attendance Code

Food Break!
10 minutes

What is Reflective Writing?

- Reflective writing is about thinking about a task you have done with the goal of doing it better next time.
- We use it at university because it can show not only that a student knows the content of the course, but also they are starting to be able to apply it professionally.
- Every job I've ever had has required some level of reflection.

What? So What? Now What?

- When you do a writing task in year two+ you must pay attention to the genre and required structure.
- For this assessment there is a specific structure we want you to follow.
- Check the lecture, workbook and videos from week 2 for more information.

Very Simply...

What?

- What was the task and what did you do?

So What?

- What did impotant things did you learn?
- What went well and what problems did you have?

Now What?

- How would you do a similar task differently in the future?

What?

- Describe what happened.
- Start by saying what the task was and what the context was.
  - *For our speaking assessment, we were asked to give a five minute presentation in groups of five.*
- This section should be factual and objective.

In the What? section, do not...

- Go too deeply into any problems.
- If there was a disaster that significantly changed your plans, you can mention it.
- Do not give your opinion of the task or your performance.

What?
Cohesive Devices and Grammar

- You are mainly telling the story of what you did.
- Use linking words indicating sequence.
  - Firstly, then, after that…
- Use (mostly) the past tense.

So What?

- Describe the important things you learned.
- Say what went well.
- Explain any issues or anything that went badly.

In the So What? Section, do not...

- Do not say you are a terrible students or be too harsh on mistakes.
- Do not overly praise (or criticise) the module or teachers.
  - If you really benefitted from it, you can maybe use one sentence to say so, but no more.
- Do not talk about solutions you didn’t actually use or how you could have avoided problems (→ Now What?)

So What?
Cohesive Devices and Grammar

- Signpost issues and opinions clearly.
  - One major problem we had…
  - An useful solution that we discovered...
- Use present tense for opinions you still hold.
  - I believe, I think
- Use past tense for a changing opinions.
  - I thought that…, but I learned…

Linking What? and So What?

- Don’t repeat what you said in the first section, but do refer back to it…
  - During the research stage, one issue I had…
  - It took me a long time to decide what to design because...

Now What?

- Say what you will do differently in the future.
  - This can be for a job.
  - It can be on other modules.
- It should be relatived to your development as an engineer/STEM professional.

In the Now What? Section...

- Don’t give overly simple resolutions.
  - In the future, I will do better.
  - In the future, I won’t forget my glasses when going to lectures.
- Make sure your resolution refers to actual module content as much as possible.
  - I will pay more attention to the implementation of guardrails in an AI application.

Now What?
Cohesive Devices and Grammar

- Use the future tense for things you would do in the future.
  - When planning another AI app, I will pay attention to…
- Use the present perfect tense to describe something you now know.
  - I have learned that…
  - I have developed my ability to…

(If you really want to stretch yourself and you have time, very brave students can look at the ‘third conditional’ -

If we had started work earlier, we would not have needed to rush the design work.)

Linking So What and Now What?

- It is easy to repeat yourself in these two sections.
  - (So What) I learned not kiss tigers at the zoo... (Now What) In future, I won’t kiss tigers in the zoo…
- Make sure you are referring back to the So What? section without saying the same thing.

  - The difficulties I experienced with platform choice mean that I’m now far more aware of the differences between different large language models.

Any Questions?

Thank You
and
Good Luck!